

Special call for Khayyam Millennium

Omar Khayyam (/ˈoʊməːr kəɪˈjɑːm/; Persian: عمر خیّام [xæjˈjɑːm]; 18 May 1048 – 4 December 1131) was a Persian mathematician, astronomer, and poet. He was born in Nishapur, in northeastern Iran, and spent most of his life near the court of the Karakhanid and Seljuq rulers in the period which witnessed the First Crusade.

As a mathematician, he is most notable for his work on the classification and solution of cubic equations, where he provided geometric solutions by the intersection of conics. Khayyam also contributed to the understanding of the parallel axiom. As an astronomer, he designed the Jalali calendar, a solar calendar with a very precise 33-year intercalation cycle.

There is a tradition of attributing poetry to Omar Khayyam, written in the form of quatrains (rubāʿiyyāt رباعیات). This poetry became widely known to the English-reading world in a translation by Edward FitzGerald (*Rubaiyat of Omar Khayyam*, 1859), which enjoyed great success in the Orientalism of the fin de siècle.

Thomas Hyde was the first European to call attention to Omar and to translate one of his quatrains into Latin (*Historia religionis veterum Persarum eorumque magorum*, 1700). Interest in Persia grew with the Orientalism movement in the 19th century. Joseph von Hammer-Purgstall (1774-1856) translated some of Khayyam's poems into German in 1818, and Gore Ouseley (1770-1844) into English in 1846, but Khayyam remained relatively unknown in the West until after the publication of Edward FitzGerald's *Rubaiyat of Omar Khayyam* in 1859. FitzGerald's work at first was unsuccessful but was popularised by Whitley Stokes from 1861 onward, and the work came to be greatly admired by the Pre-Raphaelites. In 1872 FitzGerald had a third edition printed which increased interest in the work in America. By the 1880s, the book was extremely well known throughout the English-speaking world, to the extent of the formation of numerous "Omar Khayyam Clubs" and a "fin de siècle cult of the Rubaiyat"[67]. Khayyam's poems have been translated into many languages, many of the more recent ones are more literal than that of FitzGerald.

General Goals:

- To provide suitable ground for identification of Khayyam and the Iranian thinkers and elites in different arenas: mathematics, astronomy, literature, Khayyam surveys, Islamic philosophy
- To provide grounds for identification and using the orientalists and lovers of Iranian culture and art all over the world and at international level

- To create motivation and interactions among the Iranian and foreign intellectuals

Special Goals:

- Expansion of Iranian culture and art
- Familiarity with the Iranian scientists and scholars

Convention Ranks:

- Iranian and foreign instructors, researchers and artists

Festival Calendar:

- Convention Date: 5 July 2018
- Venue: Niavaran Cultural Center
- Deadline for introducing Khayyam Lovers to the Secretariat: 20 June 2018